Utku Turk

C.V. (October 30, 2026)

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University of Maryland
College Park, MD, 20742

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INTERESTS *morphological planning in sentence production, cross-linguistic language processing, language models as models of language use, Bayesian models of response bias and judgment data, algorithmic models of linearization, adjectival morphology, degree and focus semantics, un(der)represented languages*

EDUCATION

University of Maryland, College Park, MD — 2022-2027 (expected)
Ph.D., Linguistics (advisors: Colin Phillips & Ellen Lau)
Certificate in NACS (Neuro and Cognitive Sciences)

University of Massachussets, Amherst, MA, USA — Fall 2025
Visiting Researcher, Linguistics (hosts: Shota Momma, Faruk Akkuş)
Area of Study: *Morphological planning and A-bar dependencies in Turkish*

Boğaziçi University, Turkey — 2017-2022
M.A. in Linguistics (advisor: Pavel Logačev)
Thesis title: *Agreement Attraction in Turkish*

Masaryk University, Czechia — Spring 2020
Visiting Researcher, Linguistics (hosts: Pavel Caha)
Area of Study: *case containment in Turkish, adjectival structure*

Boğaziçi University, Turkey — 2012-2017
B.A. in Translation Studies
Minor *in Spanish-Turkish translation*
Exchange student *in UCLA Linguistics*

REFEREED ARTICLES

[1] **Language-derived mental object load suppresses posterior alpha power.**
Yu, Xinchi and **Türk, Utku** and Dods, Allison and Tian, Xing and Lau, Ellen. 2027. *Journal of Neurolinguistics, 81, 101383.*

[2] **Review of 'Linguistic Illusions: A Case Study on Agreement Attraction' by Dan Parker.**
Lacina, Radim and **Türk, Utku**. In Press. *Journal of Linguistics.*

[3] **Agreement attraction in Turkish: The case of genitive attractors.**
Türk, Utku and Logačev, Pavel. 2024. *Language, Cognition and Neuroscience.*

[4] **Resources for Turkish dependency parsing: Introducing the BOUN Treebank and the BoAT annotation tool.**
Türk, Utku and Atmaca, Furkan and Özateş, Şaziye Betül and Berk, Gözde and Bedir, Seyyit Talha and Köksal, Abdullatif and Öztürk Başaran, Balkız and Güngör, Tunga and Özgür, Arzucan. 2022. *Language Resources and Evaluation.*

CHAPTERS

[5] **Controlling morphosyntactic competition through phonology.**
Türk, Utku. 2025. *Nanosyntax and the Lexicalization Algorithm (pp. 411–440). Eds. P. Caha, K. De Clercq, & G. Vanden Wyngaerd. Oxford University Press.*

[6] **The phonological nature of the Turkish front glide.**
Canalis, Stefano and Özdemir, Semra and **Türk, Utku** and Tunçer, Ümit Can. 2024. *Selected Essays on Turkish Linguistics: The Anadolu Meeting.*

SUBMITTED

[7] **(In)sensitivity to surface-level heuristics: A case from Turkish verbal attractors.**
Türk, Utku. (Minor Revisions Submitted).

IN PREP

[1] ***When do attractors attract? Controllerhood viability gates agreement attraction.***
Türk, Utku and Phillips, Colin.

[2] ***Nowhere except under negation? Russian exceptive constructions in native and heritage grammars***
Türk, Utku and Polinsky, Masha.

[3] ***Early features, late forms: The timing of tense planning in sentence production.***
Türk, Utku and Momma, Shota.

[4] *Evidence for the role of abstract subjecthood in Turkish agreement comprehension.*
Bakay, Özge and **Türk, Utku** and Demiray, Duygu and Dillon, Brian.

[5] *Grammaticality asymmetry in attraction survives response bias manipulation.*
Türk, Utku.

[6] *Weak and strong definites across languages: Experimental evidence*
Schwarz, F., Renans, A., ... & **Türk, Utku**.

[7] *Allocutivity and Grammar Competition in Turkish person marking.*
Türk, Utku.

[8] *Response bias in Turkish agreement attraction.*
Türk, Utku.

[9] *The role of register in agreement attraction.*
Türk, Utku.

TUTORIALS

[1] **generating consistent linguistic experiment materials with AI.**
Türk, Utku.

[2] **saving pcibex recordings to s3 with a python lambda.**
Türk, Utku.

[3] **montreal forced aligner workflow for pcibex production experiments.**
Türk, Utku.

CONFERENCE PUBLICATIONS

[1] **Quantifying the cross-linguistics effects of syncretism on agreement attraction.**
Türk, Utku, Neu, Eva. 2026. *Society for Computation in Linguistics.*

[2] **Frequency modulates structural choice in Turkish suspended affixation: a latent-process account.**
Türk, Utku, Neu, Eva, Bakay, Özge, Dillon, Brian; Jarosz, Gaja. 2026. *Society for Computation in Linguistics.*

[3] **Towards a theory of scope rigidity: A case of focus sensitive question particles.**
Türk, Utku and Hirsch, Aron. 2026. *Proceedings of TU+10 (10th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic).*

[4] **Syntactic alternatives in Turkish polar questions.**
Türk, Utku and Hirsch, Aron. 2026. *Proceedings of the 49th Penn Linguistics Conference (PLC 49).*

[5] **Superiority Effects With Wh-Adjuncts in Turkish.**
Lewis, Sadira and **Türk, Utku**. 2026. *Proceedings of the Linguistic Society of America.*

[6] **Hypothetical comparison in Turkish.**
Türk, Utku and Demirok, Ömer. 2021. *Proceedings of the 6th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic.*

[7] **Nanosyntactic analysis of Turkish cases.**
Türk, Utku and Caha, Pavel. 2021. *Proceedings of the 6th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic.*

[8] **Tackling the augmentative puzzle in Turkish.**
Türk, Utku. 2020. *Proceedings of the 5th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic.*

[9] **First steps towards Universal Dependencies for Laz.**
Türk, Utku and Bayar, Kaan and Özercan, Ayşegül Dilara and Öztürk, Görkem Yiğit and Özateş, Şaziye Betül. 2020. *Proceedings of the Fourth Workshop on Universal Dependencies (UDW 2020).*

[10] **Turkish treebanking: Unifying and constructing efforts.**
Türk, Utku and Atmaca, Furkan and Özateş, Şaziye Betül and Köksal, Abdullatif and Öztürk Başaran, Balkız and Güngör, Tunga and Özgür, Arzucan. 2019. *Proceedings of the 13th Linguistic Annotation Workshop.*

[11] **Improving the annotations in the Turkish Universal Dependency Treebank.**
Türk, Utku and Atmaca, Furkan and Özateş, Şaziye Betül and Öztürk Başaran, Balkız and Güngör, Tunga and Özgür, Arzucan. 2019. *Proceedings of the Third Workshop on Universal Dependencies (UDW, SyntaxFest 2019).*

RESEARCH PROJECTS

As a researcher

[1] Project title: **The Role of Working Memory in Sentence Processing** (Funded by Boğaziçi University (BAP), grant code: 17B12SUP1, 2017-2021).
Principal Investigator: Asst. Prof. Pavel Logačev.
Analysis of behavioral data from psycholinguistic experiments testing topics including response bias, grammaticality illusions, shallow processing, discourse effects. (R, Stan, brms, tidyverse, IbexFarm, git, OpenSesame, EyeLink)

[2] Project title: **Deep Learning Based Turkish Dependency Parsing** (Funded by The Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey, grant code: 117E97, 2018-2019).
Principal Investigator: Assoc. Prof. Arzucan Özgür; Project partners: Prof. Tunga Güngör and Prof. Balkız Öztürk.
Lead annotator in Universal Dependencies project for Turkish. Creating annotation guidelines for Turkish in the Universal Dependencies framework. (Python, CoNLL-U, udpipe, git, bash, Dependency Parsing, LSTMs, transformer)

[3] Project title: **Greek and Turkish in Contact: Morphosyntactic Change and its Sociological Causation** (Funded by European Commission, grant code: 120C061, 2020-2022).
Principal Investigator: Prof. Aslı Göksel & Dr. Konstantinos Sampanis, Cooperator: Asst. Prof. Metin Bağrıaçık.
Statistical analysis of the corpus and geospatial data. Sociolinguistic annotation of the first Cappadocian Greek treebank. (CoNLL-U, udpipe, tidyverse, geospatial analysis)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Maryland, College Park, MD

- *Instructor* at the Department of Linguistics — 2026
  - FALL '25 — Ling 499U: Topics in Psycholinguistics; How words are built [website]
- *Graduate Assistant* at the Department of Linguistics — 2022-2025
  - FALL '25 — Department-wide experimental and statistics helper
  - SPRING '25 — Ling 200: Introduction to Linguistics
  - FALL '24 — Ling 440: Grammars & Cognition
  - SPRING '24 — Arhu 299: Machine Learning in Language and Art [syl]
  - FALL '23 — Ling 240: Language & Mind [syl]
- *Experimental Instructor* at the Department of Linguistics — 2024
  - FALL '24 — Ling 640: Psycholinguistics

University of Oxford, UK

- *Workshop Instructor* at the Department of Linguistics — 2024
  - SUMMER '24 — Workshop on Sentence Production and Employing Production Experiments

Boğaziçi University, Turkey

- *Teaching Assistant* at the Department of Linguistics — 2018-2022
  - SPRING '22 — Ling 360: Computational Methods in Linguistics [syl]
  - SPRING '22 — Ling 314: Syntax & Semantics of Turkish [syl]
  - FALL '21 — Ling 101: Intro to Linguistics [syl]
  - FALL '21 — Ling 203: Syntax [syl]
  - SPRING '21 — Ling 101: Intro to Linguistics [syl]
  - SPRING '21 — Ling 314: Syntax & Semantics of Turkish [syl]
  - SPRING '21 — Ling 484: Comp. Methods in Linguistics [syl]
  - FALL '20 — Ling 101: Intro to Linguistics [syl]
  - FALL '20 — Ling 203: Syntax [syl]
  - FALL '20 — Ling 411: Linguistic Methodology [syl]
  - SPRING '20 — Ling 202: Morphology [syl]
  - SPRING '20 — Ling 206: Language Typology
  - FALL '19 — Ling 101: Intro to Linguistics [syl]
  - FALL '19 — Ling 313: Phonology & Morphology of Turkish [syl]
  - SPRING '19 — Ling 101: Intro to Linguistics [syl]

SPRING '19	Ling 314: Syntax & Semantics of Turkish [syl]
FALL '18	Ling 313: Phonology & Morphology of Turkish [syl]
SPRING '18	Ling 101: Intro to Linguistics [syl]
SPRING '18	Ling 102: Intro to Linguistics II [syl]
SPRING '12	Ling 102: Intro to Linguistics II

- *Class Assistant* at the Turkish Language and Culture Program 2018-2019

SUMMER 2019	S25: Upper Intermediate Turkish Classes
SUMMER 2018	S30: Advanced Turkish Classes

TALKS

[1] **Quantifying the cross-linguistic effects of syncretism on agreement attraction.**
Türk, Utku and Neu, Eva. 2026. *Talk presented at SCiL: Society for Computation in Linguistics within ACL 2026, San Diego, CA.*

[2] **Evidence for the role of abstract subjecthood in Turkish agreement comprehension.**
Bakay, Özge and **Türk, Utku** and Demiray, Duygu and Dillon, Brian. *Talk presented at the 38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP 2026), Massachusetts Institute of Technology, MA*
- Also presented as a talk at the TU+11 (11th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic), MIT and as a talk in CLS 62: Chicago Linguistics Society

[3] **Frequency modulates structural choice in Turkish suspended affixation: a latent-process account.**
Neu, Eva and **Türk, Utku** and Bakay, Özge and Dillon, Brian and Jarosz, Gaja. *Talk presented at the TU+11 (11th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic), MIT.*

[4] **Turkish register manipulation eliminates grammaticality asymmetry in attraction and challenges retrieval based accounts.**
Türk, Utku. 2025. *Talk presented at the 38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP 2025), University of Maryland, College Park, MD.*
- Also presented as a talk in TU+10 (10th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic), University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA.

[5] **Syntactic alternatives in Turkish polar questions.**
Türk, Utku and Hirsch, Aron. 2025. *Talk presented at PLC 49 (40th Penn Linguistics Circle), University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA.*

[6] **Superiority effects with adjuncts in Turkish.**
Lewis, Sadira and **Türk, Utku**. 2025. *Talk presented at the Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting (LSA 2025), Philadelphia, PA.*

[7] **When do we plan agreement in our speech: Case from agreement attraction in unaccusatives.**
Türk, Utku and Lau, Ellen and Phillips, Colin. 2024. *Talk presented at Puzzles of Agreement.*

[8] **Novel analysis of response bias challenges representational accounts in attraction.**
Türk, Utku and Logačev, Pavel. 2023. *Talk presented at Human Sentence Processing (HSP 2023), University of Pittsburgh, Pittsburgh, PA.*

[9] **Defining borrowing hierarchies in the light of sociolinguistic and geodemographic causation: Contact-induced morphosyntactic change in Asia Minor Greek.**
Sampanis, Konstantinos and **Türk, Utku** and Gülsün, Umut. 2021. *Talk presented at SLE 54 (Annual Meeting of the Societas Linguistica Europaea); online.*

[10] **The more the merrier: A new dependency treebank for Turkish.**
Türk, Utku and Atmaca, Furkan and Özateş, Şaziye Betül and Berk, Gözde and Bedir, Talha and Köksal, Abdullatif and Öztürk Başaran, Balkız and Güngör, Tunga and Özgür, Arzucan. 2020. *Talk presented at ICTL 20 (International Conference on Turkish Linguistics); online (Eskişehir, Turkey).*

[11] **Hypothetical comparison in Turkish.**
Türk, Utku and Demirok, Ömer. 2021. *Talk presented at PLC 45: Penn Linguistics Circle, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA.*
- Also presented as a talk in TU+6 (6th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic) in University of Toronto.

[12] **When vowel harmony has a say in morpho-syntax: A case from suspended affixation.**
Türk, Utku. 2021. *Talk presented at ConSOLE 29, University of Leiden; online.*

[13] **When glides are obstruents, or Turkish [j].**
Canalis, Stefano and Özdemir, Semra and **Türk, Utku** and Tunçer, Ümit Can. 2021. *Talk presented at the 18th Old World Conference in Phonology (OCP 18); online (Ibiza).*
- Also presented as a talk at *ICTL 20 (International Conference on Turkish Linguistics), Eskişehir, Turkey*

[14] **The role of shallow processing in agreement attraction.**
Türk, Utku and Logačev, Pavel. 2020. *Talk presented at Linguistic Evidence 2020, Universität Tübingen, Germany.*

[15] **Improving the annotations in the Turkish Universal Dependency Treebank.**
Türk, Utku and Atmaca, Furkan and Özateş, Şaziye Betül and Öztürk Başaran, Balkız and Güngör, Tunga and Özgür, Arzucan. 2019. *Also presented at the 33rd National Linguistics Conference (Mersin University, Turkey) 2019-05-09/2019-05-10.*.

[16] **Decomposing Turkish augmentatives.**
Türk, Utku. 2019. *Talk presented at the 16th Workshop on Syntax, Semantics, and Phonology, Universidad Complutense de Madrid, Spain.*

[17] **Is accusative case really the case?**
Türk, Utku. 2019. *Talk presented at the 13th Linguistics Student Conference, Ankara University, Turkey.*

[18] **Obligatory adjuncts within Turkish impersonals.**
Türk, Utku and Dikmen, Furkan. 2019. *Talk presented at the 13th Linguistics Student Conference, Ankara University, Turkey.*

POSTERS

[1] **Frequency modulates structural choice in Turkish suspended affixation: a latent-process account.**
Neu, Eva and **Türk, Utku** and Bakay, Özge and Dillon, Brian and Jarosz, Gaja. 2026. *Poster presented at SCiL: Society for Computation in Linguistics within ACL 2026, San Diego, CA.*
- Also presented as a poster in HSP 2026 at MIT.

[2] **Modal Competition in Inferential Contexts: Evidence from Force-Choice Experiments.**
Boukendour, Sarah and **Türk, Utku** and Williams, Alexander and Hacquard, Valentine. 2026. *Poster presented at ELM4: Experiments in Linguistics Meaning, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA.*

[3] **When do we plan agreement: Evidence from unaccusatives and agreement attraction.**
Türk, Utku and Lau, Ellen and Phillips, Colin. 2026. *Poster presented in Human Sentence Processing (HSP 2026), Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Boston, MA.*

[4] **(In)sensitivity to surface-level herusitics: A case from Turkish verbal attractors.**
Türk, Utku. 2026. *Poster presented in Human Sentence Processing (HSP 2026), Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Boston, MA.*

[5] **Turkish allows covert scrambling.**
Türk, Utku and Hirsch, Aron. 2025. *Poster presented at TU+10 (10th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic), University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA.*

[6] **Speech timing evidence on the (in)dependence of root and inflection access in production.**
Türk, Utku and Phillips, Colin. 2024. *Poster presented at Human Sentence Processing (HSP 2024), University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI.*

[7] **Is the octopus regenerating?: Comparing timing effects in sentence recall and picture description tasks.**
Dods, Allison and Macdonald, Allison and **Türk, Utku** and Mancha, Sebastián and Phillips, Colin. 2024. *Poster presented at Human Sentence Processing (HSP 2024), University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI.*

[8] **Obviation problem in Turkish.**
Türk, Utku. 2023. *Poster presented at TU+8 (8th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic), Harvard University, Cambridge, MA.*

[9] **Nanosyntactic analysis of Turkish cases.**
Türk, Utku and Caha, Pavel. 2021. *Poster presented at TU+6 (6th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic); online (University of Toronto).*

[10] **First steps towards Universal Dependencies for Laz.**
Türk, Utku and Bayar, Kaan and Özercan, Ayşegül Dilara and Özateş, Şaziye Betül. 2020. *Associated short paper in UDW 2020 proceedings.*.

[11] **The role of shallow processing in agreement attraction.**
Türk, Utku and Logačev, Pavel. 2020. *Poster presented at the 33rd Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing; online (Amherst, MA).*

[12] **An investigation into the nature of the Turkish glide [j].**
Özdemir, Semra and **Türk, Utku**. 2020. *Poster presented at TU+5 (5th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic), University of Delaware, USA.*

[13] **Tackling the augmentative puzzle in Turkish.**
Türk, Utku. 2020. *Poster presented at TU+5 (5th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic), University of Delaware, USA.*

[14] **Turkish treebanking: Unifying and constructing efforts.**
Türk, Utku and Atmaca, Furkan and Özateş, Şaziye Betül and Köksal, Abdullatif and Öztürk Başaran, Balkız and Güngör, Tunga and Özgür, Arzucan. 2019. *Associated paper in LAW XIII proceedings..*

[15] **Nanosyntax of augmentative in Turkish: Interfix -cI- analysis.**
Türk, Utku. 2019. *Poster presented at the 4th American International Morphology Meeting (AIMM4), Stony Brook University, NY.*

[16] **Nanosyntax of augmentative in Turkish: Interfix -cI- analysis.**
Türk, Utku. 2019. *Poster presented at the 13th Linguistics Student Conference, Ankara University, Turkey.*

SKILLS

- Modern languages
  - ◇ Turkish: native
  - ◇ English: proficient
  - ◇ Spanish: proficient in reading
- Programming & Experimenting
  - ◇ R & Stan & Python
  - ◇ Typst & LaTeX & JS
  - ◇ OpenSesame & PCIbex & PsychoPy

GRANTS

- LSC Mini-grant (2500 USD), University of Maryland, College Park (2025)
- ARHU Summer Fellowship (1500 USD), University of Maryland, College Park (2023 & 2024)
- Flagship Fellowship (60000 USD), University of Maryland, College Park. (2022 - 2027)
- Travel Grant for DGfs Summer School - XPrag.de Summer 2019.
- 1.5 year research grant by The Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey for Deep Learning Based Turkish Dependency Parsing project.
- Faculty of Arts and Sciences Conference Travel Grant, Boğaziçi University. Spring 2019.
- 5 year grant. Merit-based Government Funding for Higher Education, only given to top 100 students (2012 – 2017)

SERVICE

- Reviewing
  - *Journal Article Reviewer,* Journal of Memory and Language, Glossa Linguistics, Glossa Psycholinguistics, Journal of Psycholinguistic Research
  - *Reviewer,* Advances in Iranian Linguistics III
  - *Software Reviewer,* rOpenSci, pangoling R package. review available here.
  - *Reviewer,* Computational Psycholinguistic Meeting 2025 & 2026
  - *Reviewer,* DM meets Nano 2025
  - *Proceedings reviewer,* 5th/6th/11th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkish. LSA Archive.
- Conference Service
  - *Organization Committee,* MayFest Production 2026
  - *Organization Committee,* Human Sentence Processing (HSP) Conference (2025)
  - *Organization Committee,* MayFest Constraints on Meaning 2025
  - *Conference chair,* Student Conference on Linguistics, Istanbul, Turkey. SCOL 2022
  - *Conference chair,* BUSCTEL 2020: Boğaziçi University Student Conference in Theoretical and Experimental Linguistics. Department of Linguistics, Boğaziçi University
  - *Co-organizer and Reviewer,* BUSCTEL 2019
  - *Co-organizer and Reviewer,* BUSCTEL 2018
- Administrative work
  - *Senator,* University of Maryland
    (2025 - *ongoing*)
  - *Organizer,* B`{ehavioral,aby,rain,yte}`Ling Workshop, University of Maryland Linguistics
    (2024 - *ongoing*)
  - *Graduate Student Representative,* University of Maryland Linguistics (2024-2025)
  - *Board Member,* University of Maryland Language Science Center Graduate Student Board.
    (2023 - 2025)
  - *Committee Member,* University of Maryland Linguistics Colloquium Committee.
    (2023 - 2025)